

PORTS, SHIPPING & WATERWAYS A DEEP DIVE

NAVIGATING A MARITIME FUTURE

The plethora of initiatives taken in shipping and allied sectors have made India a vital force in the global maritime industry

A key factor that makes Indian ports a vital gateway to the world is their geographical location, connecting Southeast Asia, West Asia and Africa. Union minister of ports, shipping and waterways **Sarbananda Sonowal** charts the rapid strides India's ports and allied sectors have made since 2014.

SAGARMALA

In the last eight years, various initiatives under the SagarMala programme have helped in lowering overall operational cost of ports, reducing turnaround time for vessels, increasing efficiency, adding ability to handle larger ships, and developing strategic importance of Indian ports in the South Asian region. This helped the ports transport a record $450 billion worth of goods in 2022-23.

GATI SHAKTI

Thanks to the initiatives under Prime Minister Gati Shakti National Master Plan and National Logistic Policy 2022, India's major ports are seeing double digit annual growth. As per the recent World Bank Logistic Performance Index report, India moved up from 44th rank in the international shipment category in 2019 to 22nd in 2022. In shipment delivery times, the country jumped from 52nd position in 2018 to 35th in 2023. Today, our average container turnaround time—0.9 days—is better than countries such as the US, Germany, Canada and Australia.

CARGO BOOST

The aim is to boost cargo handling by our ports to 7,000 million tonne per annum, from the current 1,300 million tonne. We anticipate that by 2030, more than 85 per cent of cargo will be handled at landlord ports, eventually culminating in full transition by 2047. The Jawaharlal Nehru Port Authority has already achieved 100 per cent PPP operated port status under this model. At the recently concluded Global